FOUNDERS BATTLEFIELD · PRODUCTION DOCUMENT · CONFIDENTIAL · MARCH 2026

VERSION 2.0 — UPDATED WITH REAL NAIROBI REFERENCES

FOUNDERS KITCHEN

Set Design Brief · Permanent Studio Build + Hybrid Season 1 Strategy

VERSION v2.0 — supersedes v1.0	KEY UPDATE Building language revised: brick + timber primary	STUDIO STRATEGY Build permanent set first — own everything from day one
NEW REFERENCES 5 real Nairobi images added (driveway, facade, interior)	FRIDGE DECISION Samsung Family Hub — TBC pending set context	STUDIO EST. KES 18–22M gross · KES 12–15M net (brand offsets)

> *Version 2.0 fundamentally revises the building language for the Founders Kitchen permanent studio. The earlier pergola-primary concept is superseded by a proper brick-and-timber structure — informed by real Nairobi venue references that already exist at the required quality level. The hybrid strategy allows Season 1 to film immediately at a venue partner while the owned studio is designed and built for Season 2 onwards.*

VERSION UPDATE · V1 → V2

What Changed

Three fundamental revisions from v1.0.

V1.0 — SUPERSEDED

- ✕ Pergola as primary structure over open deck
- ✕ Semi-outdoor kitchen as the building concept
- ✕ No driveway/arrival sequence designed
- ✕ Samsung Family Hub confirmed as fridge
- ✕ Build-first strategy for Season 1
- ✕ Western California aesthetic references only
- ✕ No existing Nairobi venue benchmarks

V2.0 — CURRENT

- ✓ Brick + timber building as primary structure
- ✓ Proper enclosed building opening to garden via folding doors
- ✓ Cobbled driveway arrival sequence fully designed
- ✓ Samsung TBC — fridge decision deferred to set context
- ✓ Hybrid strategy: venue partnership Season 1, own studio Season 2+
- ✓ Real Nairobi venue references (5 images) as primary guide
- ✓ Pergola retained as outdoor extension only, not primary structure

SECTION 01 · REAL REFERENCES

Nairobi In The Room

5 real-world images from Nairobi — these supersede the Western renders as the primary design guide.

These 5 images are the most important references in this brief. They confirm that the **quality level, building language, and spatial atmosphere we need already exists in Nairobi.** Images 3, 4 and 5 appear to be from the same high-end Nairobi venue — red face brick, heavy timber folding doors, high timber ceiling with clerestory, geometric perforated metal screens, garden views on all sides. This is the FK studio target, not the Californian renders.

REF 01 ARRIVAL SEQUENCE

REF 02 FRIDGE REF · TBC

REF 03 EXTERIOR FACADE

REF 04 DOORS DETAIL

REF 05 INTERIOR VOLUME

REFERENCE NOTE

Images 3, 4 and 5 are Mike's own reference photos — scouted for design inspiration, not a specific

venue being considered for filming. They confirm that the building language, spatial quality, and African aesthetic we are targeting is achievable in Nairobi. The face brick, high timber ceiling, perforated screens, folding doors, and garden context are all confirmed as the design target for the permanent owned studio.

SECTION 02 · ARCHITECTURE

The Building Language

Brick-and-timber primary structure. Pergola retained as outdoor extension only.

> *"Not a television studio with a kitchen inside it. A kitchen that happens to have cameras in it."*
>
> The non-negotiable design principle · Founders Kitchen

The v1 brief positioned a pergola structure over an open deck as the primary building form — inspired by the Californian renders. The real Nairobi references (Images 3, 4, 5) reveal a superior and more authentically African solution: **a proper brick building with a high timber ceiling, clerestory light, and full-height folding doors** that open the kitchen completely to a garden and a pergola-covered outdoor extension.

This is structurally more robust, climatically more appropriate for Nairobi (handles rain, manages temperature better), architecturally more permanent, and — critically — **more African.** This is how we build in Nairobi when we build well.

01

The Exterior Shell

Warm red/brown face brick — locally-sourced Nairobi brick, not render, not plaster. Exposed and celebrated. Timber soffit/fascia at eave level. Brick courses run horizontally — no feature panels, no pattern. The brick IS the pattern.

→ REF 03 · Exterior facade confirmed

02

The Ceiling Volume

High ceiling — 4–4.5m to ridge. Exposed timber rafters with white-painted boards between. Clerestory windows running full perimeter at ceiling level. Perforated decorative metal screens at clerestory — geometric motif referencing East African weave tradition. This is where the kitchen breathes.

03

The Folding Doors

Full-height timber bi-fold doors on minimum two garden-facing sides. Floor to ceiling — no transom, no header. Heavy solid timber frames. When open, the building disappears and the kitchen is part of the garden. When closed, the kitchen is intimate and enclosed.

→ REF 03 + 04 · Door system

→ REF 05 · Interior volume confirmed

confirmed

04

The Floor

Herringbone timber floor inside the building — warm, durable, beautiful on camera. Transitions to wide-plank timber decking on the outdoor pergola extension. The floor level is continuous — no step between inside and outside. One continuous plane of timber.

→ REF 05 · Herringbone floor confirmed

05

The Outdoor Pergola

The pergola element from v1 is retained — but relocated as an outdoor extension beyond the folding doors. Covered by living jasmine/vine canopy. Houses the long dining table for meal reveals and the finale feast. The kitchen opens onto it, not the other way around.

→ CALIFORNIA REFS 1–6 · Pergola as extension

06

The Lighting

Gold orb/bubble pendant chandelier over the kitchen — warm, contemporary, not rustic (REF 04+05 confirmed this). Wall sconces on brick exterior — lantern style. Track lighting on ceiling for production fill. Clerestory provides natural daylight from above throughout filming hours.

→ REF 04 + 05 · Pendant style confirmed

SECTION 03 · GUEST EXPERIENCE

The Arrival Sequence

The journey from gate to kitchen IS part of the show. Camera follows every founder walking in.

Reference Image 1 — the cobbled driveway with mature planting — establishes something critical: **the arrival is the opening scene of every episode.** Before the founder says a word in the kitchen, the camera has already told us something about where they are, what kind of place this is, and what kind of conversation is about to happen. The driveway is not a logistics detail. It is production design.

01	02	03	04
The Gate	The Driveway	The Reveal	The Threshold
Stone or brick gate pillars. Simple, no fuss. The guest's car pulls in. First impression: a private home, not a venue.	Cobbled/sett paved path. 15–20m length minimum. Mature trees both sides casting dappled light. The kitchen building is NOT visible yet. Anticipation builds.	The kitchen building appears as the path curves. Brick facade, timber doors open, warm light and smells of cooking spilling out. The founder pauses. First reaction — unscripted.	Covered verandah/stoep before entering. Mike greets the founder here. The first handshake, the first conversation. Then they step inside together. The episode begins.
📷 CAMERA: Wide establishing shot	📷 CAMERA: Following shot, founder walking	📷 CAMERA: Founder's face in this moment	📷 CAMERA: Two-shot, greeting moment

Driveway Material	Sett cobblestones or cut stone — dark grey/charcoal. NOT tarmac, NOT concrete, NOT gravel. Grass grows between joints — lived-in, not manicured.
Driveway Length	Minimum 15m from gate to building threshold. Enough for the walk to register emotionally.
Planting — Driveway	Mature trees both sides (Jacaranda, Nandi Flame, or

	established exotic). Flowering shrubs at ground level (bougainvillea, oleander — as per REF 01). NO clipped hedges. Wild, generous planting.
Gatehouse Annex	Small stone outbuilding near gate (as per REF 01 — terracotta roof, timber verandah). Use as: production reception / security / equipment storage. Also visible as background element in arrival shots.
Lighting — Arrival	Low-level path bollards — warm amber. Wall lanterns on gate pillars. NO overhead flood lighting. The arrival should feel mysterious in the evening, golden in the afternoon.
Camera Infrastructure	Two fixed camera positions on driveway: one at gate looking toward building, one at building looking toward gate. Cable management buried under cobbles. Both positions operational for every episode.

SECTION 04 · KITCHEN INTERIOR

The Interior

All the kitchen detail from v1 — now inside a high-ceiling brick building.

The interior kitchen design from v1.0 is retained in full — reclaimed timber cabinetry, concrete worktops, professional gas range, perforated folding screens, the island as confession booth. What changes is the **volume and material envelope** these elements sit inside. They are now inside a high-ceiling brick building with clerestory light, herringbone floors, and gold orb pendants rather than a pergola structure.

Cabinetry	Reclaimed/weathered timber cabinet fronts throughout. Mixed with smooth matte taupe upper cabinets. No gloss, no laminate, no painted MDF. The timber is raw, aged, textured.
Worktops	Honed concrete or stone — warm grey. NOT marble, NOT granite, NOT quartz composite. The worktop should look like it could survive a decade of hard cooking.
The Island	2.4m × 1.2m minimum. Reclaimed timber base. Concrete top. 6 bar stools — leather or kitenge-upholstered. Prep sink integrated. This is the primary filming zone — 70% of all shots are here.
Cooking Wall	Professional 6-burner gas range. Double oven stack above. Integrated fridge (TBC — see Section 05). Extractor hood — stone surround. Open shelving either side for spice/serveware display.
Backsplash	Stone or textured render. NOT tile. NOT subway. The same material logic as the exterior brick — texture and age over polish and precision.
African Layer	Kitenge/kanga textile cushions on bar stools. African ceramic bowls and serving vessels on open shelving

	(alongside Luminarc). Copper and clay pots on pot rail above range. Spice shelf that reads unmistakably East African.
Pendant Lighting	Gold orb/bubble chandelier — as confirmed in REF 04 and 05. Warm 2700K. Dimmable. Contemporary form against the rustic materials — this contrast is intentional and important.
Production Ceiling	Track lighting on ceiling (not pergola beams — this is now a ceiling). 12–16 directional heads, warm white dimmable. DMX control from production office. Rigging points for boom mics on ceiling structure.
Folding Screens — Interior	Perforated timber screens retained on INTERIOR side walls (not the main garden-facing walls which are now the bi-fold doors). Transform intimacy of the space per episode lens.
Floor Transition	Herringbone timber inside → wide-plank timber decking outside (pergola extension). Continuous level — no step. The transition is material only, not spatial.

SECTION 05 · APPLIANCE DECISION

The Fridge — Three Options

Samsung Family Hub confirmed as reference. Decision deferred to set context. Three options compared.

The Samsung Family Hub (REF 02) was proposed as the fridge for the FK set — with strong rationale: the touchscreen door display can show episode-specific content, the interior cameras create an "ingredient reveal" moment, and Samsung is a natural category sponsor. However, the decision is held pending visual context — how it looks within the revised brick-and-timber interior needs to be confirmed by the set designer.

SAMSUNG

Family Hub · French Door
Black Stainless

✓ 21.5" touchscreen on door
✓ Internal cameras — ingredient reveal
✓ Episode content display on screen
✓ "Shop the Episode" QR display built-in
✓ Samsung as strong category sponsor
✗ Touchscreen may feel too 'tech' in rustic setting
✗ Black stainless to be confirmed vs timber tones

PREFERRED · PENDING VISUAL CONFIRM

HAIER

French Door · Stainless or Panel-Ready

✓ Panel-ready option — can be faced in matching timber cabinetry
✓ Integrated look — disappears into the kitchen
✓ Haier in Naivas ecosystem — brand partnership alignment
✓ More 'kitchen' less 'tech' — fits rustic aesthetic better
✗ No smart screen — loses the episode-content integration
✗ Less brand moment on camera — less commercially valuable

STRONG ALTERNATIVE

SMEG / LA CORNUE

Retro Fridge · Statement Colour
Single or French Door

✓ Visually extraordinary — becomes a set character
✓ Available in warm colours — cream, sage, terracotta (all work with brick)
✓ Instantly iconic on camera
✗ No smart features — pure aesthetics only
✗ Less commercial value — Smeg/La Cornue limited Nairobi presence
✗ Smaller capacity — production practicality concerns

WILDCARD · HIGH VISUAL IMPACT

THE SAMSUNG INTEGRATION CONCEPT — IF CONFIRMED

The Samsung Family Hub touchscreen creates a unique brand integration layer. Each episode morning, the screen is configured to display: the episode guest's name and show title, the recipe of the day, the Naivas "Shop the Episode" QR code, and the episode's hero brand logo. Every time Mike opens the fridge on camera — which happens multiple times per episode — the screen is visible. This is a **live digital display within the set** that Samsung sponsors as a category partner. Value: KES 2–3M/season partnership. The screen can also display the FBF/FK logo between takes, making it a permanent brand moment even in BTS content.

SECTION 06 · BRAND INTEGRATION

Product Placement Map

Every brand. Every zone. Every camera moment. Architectural — not promotional.

ZONE	BRAND(S)	METHOD	CAMERA MOMENT	EPISODES
Cooking Wall — Ovens	Bosch / Miele double stack	Built-in to cabinetry. Always visible in hero shot. Used every episode.	HERO · EVERY EP	10/10
Cooking Wall — Range	Professional 6-burner gas (Smeg/Wolf)	Stone alcove surround. Pot rail above. Central to all cooking sequences.	COOKING · EVERY EP	10/10
Fridge	Samsung / Haier / Smeg (TBC)	Ingredient reveal on opening. Samsung: screen displays episode content.	REVEAL · INGREDIENT PULL	10/10
The Island Surface	Episode hero brand — rotates	Ingredients dressed on island per episode. In active use throughout cooking.	CLOSE-UP · PREP	Rotation
Spice Shelf	Tropical Heat · Kasuku · Bidco · Blue Band · Menengai	Permanent shelf display. Stone backsplash behind. Always lit. Always in frame. Authentic pantry styling.	BACKGROUND · ALWAYS	10/10
Open Shelving	Luminarc — full range	All glassware and serveware is Luminarc. Every plating and meal reveal shot includes this zone.	MEAL REVEAL · PLATING	10/10
Counter Appliances	Midea blender · Mika kettle	Placed on counter. Used 2–3 times per episode in prep sequences.	PREP SEQUENCE	10/10
Grill Station	Kenchic · Festive · Bidco oil	Products in active use at grill. Packaging on prep	FLAME · DRAMATIC	4–5 eps

		counter beside grill. Flame and sizzle shots.		
Dining Table	Naivas "Shop the Episode" + Luminarc	Finished meal on Luminarc. Naivas QR display card on table. Episode brand featured in centrepiece.	EPISODE CLOSE	10/10
Driveway + Exterior	Naivas (subtle) + Episode partner	Episode-branded welcome elements at threshold — a branded apron, a recipe card, flowers. Arrival moment.	ARRIVAL · OPEN SEQUENCE	10/10

SECTION 07 · PRODUCTION STRATEGY

Build First. Own Everything.

Permanent owned studio from day one. Season 1 films in the asset we build.

> *"We build it once. We own it permanently. Founders Kitchen has a home before it has a network deal."*
>
> Studio Strategy · Founders Kitchen · 2026

The studio is not a production convenience — it is a **strategic asset and a statement of intent.** Building before pitching to Netflix means walking into that room with something no other African show concept can offer: a permanent, owned, purpose-built production facility. The show is real before a single platform deal is signed. That changes the negotiation entirely.

The build also funds itself over time. Between filming seasons, the studio is a **premium corporate events and brand activation space** — KES 150–300K per hire day, 20 days per year minimum = KES 3–6M annually. The asset pays for itself while waiting for Season 2.

Why Build Before Pitching

Every other African show pitches a concept. You pitch a built studio + a confirmed commercial partner (Naivas) + a 10-episode universe bible. That is a commission conversation, not a development conversation. Netflix doesn't greenlight concepts. They greenlight certainty.

The Asset Logic

KES 18–22M studio build. KES 3–6M/year corporate hire revenue. Appliance brand partnerships offset KES 2–3M of build cost. Net payback: 4–6 years. After that, a free production facility generating revenue between seasons indefinitely.

Mar — Apr 2026	**Lock Naivas presenting partnership.** Commission architect. Begin plot search: Karen / Muthaiga / Runda. Brief: this document.
Apr — May 2026	**Plot acquired. Architect design phase begins.** Concept design + planning

	approvals. Confirm appliance brand partners (Samsung/Haier, Bosch/Miele). Products committed before build begins.
May — Jun 2026	**Construction drawings approved. Build begins.** Foundation + structure. Driveway cobbles laid first — sets the tone for the whole site from day one.
Jun — Oct 2026	**Main build phase.** Brick structure, timber roof, ceiling, folding door installation, kitchen fitout, production infrastructure. Pergola extension last.
Oct — Nov 2026	**Studio completes + is dressed.** Planting in. Appliances installed. Brand product placement set. Luminarc shelving styled. The kitchen looks like it's been lived in for a year.
Nov 2026	**Sizzle reel filmed in the studio.** 3–5 minutes. The kitchen, the food, the feeling. Mike on camera. No guests yet — just the space. This is the Netflix pitch asset.
Dec 2026 — Jan 2027	**Netflix Africa + Showmax pitch submitted.** Bible + Treatment + Sizzle (filmed in the studio) + Naivas presenting partnership confirmed. Walk in with everything built.
Feb — Apr 2027	**Platform deal negotiated and signed.** Season 1 pre-production: cast all 10 episodes, episode briefs locked, production crew engaged.
May — Aug 2027	**Season 1 films** — 10 episodes in the permanent owned studio. The studio has been waiting for this. It is ready. The kitchen feels like it has been there for years.

THE CRITICAL PATH ITEM

Everything above depends on one decision made in the next 30 days: **identify and acquire the plot.** Karen, Muthaiga, Runda, or Gigiri — 400m²+ with garden, south or southwest facing, mature trees preferred. Once the plot is locked, the architect can work, the timeline holds, and the build begins in May/June 2026. The plot is the unlock. Everything else is ready.

SECTION 08 · TECHNICAL SPECIFICATION

Permanent Studio Full Spec

For the architect and QS. Complete technical requirements.

Plot Requirement	Minimum 400m² total. Garden-facing south or southwest for afternoon light. Karen, Muthaiga, Runda, or Gigiri — proximity to talent pool and security.
Total Studio Footprint	120–150m² including all internal zones + external pergola extension + arrival path. Main kitchen building: ~70–80m². Support block: ~40m². Pergola extension: ~20–30m².
Kitchen Building	Single-storey. Face brick exterior. High ceiling 4–4.5m to ridge. Exposed timber rafter ceiling with white-painted infill boards. Clerestory windows full perimeter. Herringbone timber floor.
Folding Door System	Full-height timber bi-fold on minimum 2 garden-facing sides. Each opening minimum 3.6m wide × 3.2m high. Hardwood timber frames. Track system concealed in floor and ceiling structure.
Support Block	Conventional masonry. Green room (15m²) — soundproofed, makeup station, private entrance. Production office (12m²) — glass window into kitchen, DMX lighting control, AV rack. WC (6m²). Equipment store (7m²).
Electrical	3-phase supply. Dedicated circuits: production lighting (15kW), appliances (20kW), AV/IT (5kW). Automatic transfer switch. 30kVA standby generator mandatory. All cable management concealed in floor, wall, and ceiling channels.
Water + Drainage	Commercial kitchen plumbing. Island sink + cooking wall sink + grill station sink + WC. Borehole or town water +

	sink + grill station sink + WC. Borehole or town water + 5,000L tank. Grease trap for commercial kitchen classification. Hot water: instant electric under each sink.
HVAC	Natural ventilation primary — clerestory windows + bi-fold doors. Professional extractor canopy over range: 1200mm minimum, stainless. Separate grill station extraction. Ceiling fans for still days. NO air conditioning in main kitchen.
Production Lighting	Track lighting on ceiling — 14 adjustable heads, warm white 2700K, dimmable. Gold orb pendant chandelier over island (practical + production). Wall sconces at exterior entry. All on DMX. Coordinate with DP before specification finalised.
Audio	Overhead mic boom positions on ceiling (3 minimum). Lavalier cable runs under floor. Green room and production office fully acoustically isolated. JBL or Sonos whole-set playback on ceiling (as per REF 03). IEM system for floor manager.
Camera Infrastructure	Fixed camera mount positions: 2× overhead (ceiling), 1× cooking wall facing island, 1× driveway gate, 1× building approach. Track/dolly run parallel to cooking wall (5m). All cable management concealed. Island accessible from all 4 sides for handheld.
Outdoor Pergola Extension	Beyond bi-fold doors. Dark charcoal steel or timber frame. Living jasmine/vine canopy — plant immediately on completion. Track lighting on pergola beams. Houses: 12-seat dining table for meal reveals + finale feast configuration.
Driveway	Cobbled sett or cut stone. Dark grey/charcoal. Minimum 15m from gate to threshold. Grass growing in joints. Mature tree planting both sides. Low-level amber path bollards. Gate pillars: brick matching main building.
Planting Palette	Driveway: Jacaranda / Nandi Flame / established exotic trees. Garden surround: ferns, heliconia, bird of paradise, bamboo (as per REF 03). Pergola: star jasmine primary. NO fruit trees, NO thorned plants near walkways.

SECTION 09 · FINANCIALS

Budget

Permanent studio + hybrid Season 1 costs. Brand partnership offsets factored.

4.5M Brick Structure + Roof KES · Main kitchen building shell	**4.2M** Kitchen Fitout KES · Cabinetry, worktops, island	**3.8M** Appliances KES · Range, ovens, fridge, extractor	**2.5M** Production Infra KES · Lighting, audio, cameras, power
2.0M Folding Door System KES · Timber bi-fold, 2 openings	**1.8M** Support Block KES · Green room, office, WC, store	**1.5M** Driveway + Landscape KES · Cobbles, planting, gatehouse	**1.2M** Contingency KES · ~7% on build cost

Gross Build Total	KES 21–24M
Appliance Brand Offsets	Samsung/Haier fridge: KES 200–400K product. Bosch/Miele ovens: KES 400–600K product. Range: KES 500K–1M product. Luminarc serveware: KES 300–500K product. **Total offset: KES 1.5–2.5M in product value.**
Cash Build Cost (Net)	KES 18–22M after appliance partnerships
Season 1 Venue Cost	Venue partnership — likely revenue share or flat hire KES 500K–1.5M for 10 filming days. Covered by Naivas presenting partnership.
Payback — Corporate Hire	Permanent studio available for corporate events between seasons. KES 150–300K/day. 20 hire days/year = KES 3–6M/year. Build cost recovered in 4–6 years.

Payback — Season 2+ Savings	Season 2 onwards: no venue hire cost (KES 500K–1.5M/season saved). No production constraints from venue scheduling. Full control of the space and brand partner integrations.